

Zheng (Patrick) TONG

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7/F, The Jockey Club Tower, Centennial Campus, The University of Hong Kong, Pokfulam, Hong Kong

EDUCATION

The University of Hong Kong

Hong Kong

Master of Social Sciences, Social Data Analytics, *with Distinction*

Sep. 2025 – Nov. 2026

- **GPA:** 3.83/4.30
- **Major Courses:** Introduction to Social Data Analytics (A+); Programming for Social Scientists (A); Statistical Foundations (A-); Machine Learning (B+); Natural Language Processing and Social Research (A); Social Network Analysis (A); Big Data Solutions to Social Problems (A)
- **Thesis:** *The Causal Effects of Family Rural-to-Urban Migration on Rural-Origin Children's Educational Outcomes in China* (A)

Macau University of Science and Technology

Macau

Bachelor of Arts, Journalism and Communication, *with First Class Honors*

Sep. 2021 – May 2025

- **GPA:** 3.77/4.00
- **Major Courses:** Social Statistics (A+); Mathematics and Logic (A+); Data Journalism (A+); Advanced Theories in Communication (A+); Digital Narrative (A+); Audience Analysis (A); Communication Psychology (A)

National University of Singapore

Singapore

Summer School for Social Science Research Methods

Jun. 2025 – Jul. 2025

- Completed intensive training in *Survey Research* (Distinction) and *AI & Experimental Methods* (Merit), with a focus on applying computational tools to social science research
- Developed hands-on expertise in sampling strategies, survey mode selection, questionnaire design, and statistical weighting
- Applied LLMs and R to experimental research tasks, including stimuli generation, coding and analysis automation, randomization design, and survey/conjoint experiment design

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Computational Social Science; Political Communication; AI and Communication; Migration Studies; Causal Inference; Natural Language Processing (NLP)

CONFERENCE PAPERS

Speaking as the People, the Protector, or the Provocateur: Rhetorical Persona Types in U.S. Presidential Campaign Speeches (1952–2024) (Single-authored)

Accepted for presentation at the 112th Annual Convention of the National Communication Association (NCA), Political Communication Division

New Orleans, Louisiana, United States, Nov. 2026

- Developed a person-centered framework that reconceptualizes U.S. presidential campaign rhetoric as recurring multidimensional personae rather than a single continuum of populism
- Designed a latent profile analysis (LPA) of full-text campaign speeches (1952–2024) to identify speech-level personae, construct candidate-level rhetorical signatures, and compare their distribution across parties, periods, and candidates

When Home Moves Away: The Causal Effect of Parental Rural-to-Urban Migration on Rural-Origin Children's Intergenerational Ties in China (Single-authored)

Accepted for presentation at the 112th Annual Convention of the National Communication Association (NCA), Family Communication Division

New Orleans, Louisiana, United States, Nov. 2026

- Reframed parental rural-to-urban migration as a reorganization of the family communication environment, comparing how left-behind, co-migrant, and non-migrant arrangements reshape children's intergenerational ties
- Designed a propensity-score-weighted difference-in-differences (PSW-DiD) analysis of CFPS panel data, using repeated measures of parent-child communication, emotional attention, monitoring, and conflict

Exclusionary Populism in the U.S.: From Party-Wide Patterns to Trump's Rhetoric (Single-authored)

Presented at the International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR) 2026, Political Communication Research Section (POL); Served as Panel Chair

Galway, Ireland, Jun.–Jul. 2026

- Constructed a party-month panel of U.S. presidential campaign speeches (1952–2024) and developed a LIWC-based *they-we* gap and party-standardized Exclusionary Populism Index (EPI)
- Found that Republicans used relatively more "*they*" than "*we*," that prior elite rhetoric widened the subsequent *they-we* gap while people-centered rhetoric narrowed it, and Trump amplified broader Republican exclusionary trends

When the Dead Seem Present: Perceived Realism, Social Presence, and Psychological Mechanisms in AI-Based Digital Resurrection (Single-authored)

Presented at the International Association for Media and Communication Research (IAMCR) 2026, Ethics of Society and Ethics of Communication Working Group (ETH)

Galway, Ireland, Jun.–Jul. 2026

- Developed a mechanism model explaining how perceived realism shapes willingness to use AI-based digital resurrection through parallel pathways of emotional comfort and uncanny discomfort, conditional on social presence
- Designed a preregistered three-condition Qualtrics experiment in mainland China, manipulating technical fidelity while holding the memorial persona, message, and duration constant

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

The University of Hong Kong

Hong Kong

Teaching Assistant (Full-time), Faculty of Social Sciences

Sep. 2026 – Aug. 2027

- Expected to support teaching and course administration for the Master of Social Sciences programmes in Social Data Analytics and Population and Policy Analysis
- Responsibilities will include course preparation, assignment and test marking, feedback provision, examination invigilation, student consultation, and other academic support duties
- Expected to assist in courses related to programming, statistics, machine learning, big data analytics, natural language processing, and social network analysis, subject to course allocation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Southern Metropolis Daily

Zhuhai, China

News Reporter and Editor Intern

Jun. 2024 – Sep. 2024

- Gathered, wrote, and edited daily news articles or videos per week, covering a wide range of topics including politics, local issues, and economics
- Curated digital content layouts and personalized news recommendations, improving click-through performance on the featured homepage
- Digitized and archived high-performing legacy articles to enrich the newspaper's online content library

Shenzhen Special Zone Daily

Shenzhen, China

News Reporter Intern

Jun. 2023 – Aug. 2023

- Investigated the social impact of urbanization on migrant workers through stakeholder collaboration and socioeconomic data analysis and visualization
- Conducted field interviews with urban planners, NGOs, and affected migrant workers to inform a three-part feature series
- Authored a feature series that boosted online engagement and was cited by local NGOs and policy advisors

Wuhan Traffic Broadcasting Station

Wuhan, China

New Media Editor Intern

Jun. 2022 – Aug. 2022

- Managed official social media platforms (Weibo, Douyin, WeChat), producing news and video content for daily updates
- Collected, visualized, and published COVID-19 case trajectory data to guide public safety decisions during the pandemic, reaching a broad online audience
- Created multimedia content across platforms, contributing to stronger audience engagement across daily posts

HONORS & AWARDS

- Conference Sponsorship, Faculty of Social Sciences, The University of Hong Kong 2026
- Dean's Honor List Scholarship, Macau University of Science and Technology 2021 – 2025
- Dean's Honor List, Macau University of Science and Technology 2021 – 2025

SERVICE & AFFILIATIONS

AP1xClub

Macau

Community & Content Coordinator

Dec. 2024 – Dec. 2025

- Supported a student-led academic workshop community by coordinating peer-sharing events and alumni talks on academic writing, literature review, database searching, and AI-assisted research workflows
- Developed and curated academic content and learning resources to facilitate peer knowledge exchange and promote practical research skills among students

Macau University of Science and Technology Volunteer Association

Macau

Head of the Secretariat

Dec. 2023 – Feb. 2025

- Streamlined cross-department operations by building daily management processes and performance tracking; organized 20+ volunteer initiatives (e.g., blood donation, community clean-ups) engaging over a thousand students
- Coordinated internal communications, meeting records, and event logistics across departments, ensuring smooth execution of association activities and more efficient collaboration among student volunteers

SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, XGBoost, statsmodels, NLTK, NetworkX), R, HTML/CSS, $\LaTeX$
- **Research Methods:** Statistical Analysis, Causal Inference, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Computational Text Analysis, Big Data Analysis, Social Network Analysis, Survey Experiments
- **Research Tools & Software:** SPSS, Qualtrics, Gephi, NVivo, ATLAS.ti (*Certified Student Trainer*), GitHub, Adobe XD & Photoshop
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (Proficient)